

Course Policies

A student-friendly guide to participation, inclusion, accommodations, academic integrity, assessment, and professional development

What matters most

Be engaged. Be respectful. Do your own work. Ask questions when something is unclear. Use available support and accommodations when needed.

1. Attendance & Active Participation

This course uses lectures, assigned readings, class participation, mini-projects, and quizzes. Active participation is an important part of learning and contributes to your course grade.

The classroom is more than a place to receive information. It is also preparation for post-graduate life, where critical thinking, communication, collaboration, and problem-solving are essential. These skills are strengthened through active engagement with course material, discussion with peers, and thoughtful reflection.

2. Inclusive Learning Environment

We are committed to an inclusive learning environment in which all students feel safe, welcomed, and respected. Students of all ages, backgrounds, beliefs, ethnicities, genders, identities, national origins, religious affiliations, sexual orientations, abilities, and other visible and non-visible differences are welcome.

Each student's individuality and perspective will be respected. In return, all students are expected to treat classmates, teaching staff, and the instructor with respect at all times.

3. Disability Accommodations & Access

The Bioengineering Department is committed to ensuring access to classes, course materials, and learning opportunities for all students.

If you have an accommodation letter from Disability Resources for Students (DRS), please share it with the instructor and discuss the accommodations you may need. If you have not yet established services through DRS but have a temporary health condition or a permanent disability that may require accommodations, you are encouraged to contact DRS.

- Location: 011 Mary Gates Hall
- Phone: 206-543-8924
- Email: uwdrs@uw.edu
- Web: disability.uw.edu

Accommodations are established through an interactive process involving the student, instructor(s), and DRS.

4. Academic Integrity & Conduct

The UW Bioengineering Department is committed to the highest academic standards. Students are expected to uphold honesty, respect, responsibility, and integrity in all course activities and to follow the University of Washington Student Conduct Code.

Under the College of Engineering Academic Misconduct Policy, examples of academic misconduct include:

- Cheating on examinations.
- Plagiarism or cheating on individual projects.
- Stealing or altering another person's academic work in order to improve one's own grade or receive academic credit.

What is plagiarism?

Plagiarism includes using another person's ideas, writing, inventions, or other work without appropriate acknowledgment. Giving credit to the original source is essential.

Important: Citation alone does not make extensive copying acceptable. Your writing should be genuinely your own - including your wording, sentence structure, and organization - unless you are using a properly identified quotation.

If you are unsure whether something constitutes plagiarism, please ask the instructor before submitting your work.

5. VeriCite Notice

The University has a license agreement with VeriCite, an educational tool used to help identify or prevent plagiarism from Internet resources. The instructor may require assignments to be submitted electronically for review through VeriCite.

A VeriCite report may indicate the amount of original text in submitted work and whether quoted, paraphrased, summarized, or otherwise borrowed material is appropriately referenced.

6. Course Learning & Assessment

The course is designed as a progression from learning to practice to demonstration:

LEARN Develop concepts and skills through lectures and readings.	PRACTICE Apply and strengthen skills through homework and mini-projects.
CHECK Verify understanding through classroom exercises and quizzes.	DEMONSTRATE Integrate and apply learning in an end-of-term project.

7. Educational & Professional Goals

Students completing this course are being advanced toward:

- Pursuing advanced degrees and/or obtaining employment in bioengineering-related fields, such as medicine, medical device development, or biotechnology.
- Advancing their careers by obtaining appropriate educational and professional qualifications.
- Contributing to the responsible development of new technical knowledge.
- Addressing unmet needs in medicine and biotechnology.